

NEXUS TECHNOLOGIES INC.

Employee Handbook & Operational Guidelines

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Confidentiality Level: Internal Distribution Only

1. Welcome to Nexus Technologies

1.1 A Message from Leadership

Welcome to Nexus Technologies! We are thrilled to have you join our team of engineers, designers, strategists, and innovators. You were chosen because of your exceptional talent, drive, and passion for building technology that solves complex problems.

At Nexus, we believe that innovation happens at the intersection of autonomy, collaboration, and high standards. This handbook serves as your guide to our company culture, policies, and expectations. Please read it carefully, keep it as a reference, and reach out to the People Operations team if you have any questions.

1.2 Company Mission & Core Values

- **Mission:** To engineer intelligent, scalable infrastructure that empowers businesses to build the future seamlessly.
- **Core Values:**
 - **Relentless Curiosity:** We never stop learning, questioning, and experimenting.
 - **Radical Ownership:** We take end-to-end responsibility for our code, our products, and our impact.
 - **Velocity with Precision:** We move fast, ship iteratively, but never compromise on architectural integrity or quality.

- **Inclusive Collaboration:** Great ideas can come from anywhere; diverse perspectives make our systems and teams stronger.

1.3 About This Handbook

This employee handbook outlines general policies, benefits, and guidelines of Nexus Technologies Inc. (the "Company").

Important Note: This handbook is not a contract of employment. Employment with Nexus Technologies is on an **at-will** basis, meaning that either you or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice.

2. Employment Basics & Workplace Standards

2.1 Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO)

Nexus Technologies is an Equal Opportunity Employer. We celebrate diversity and are committed to creating an inclusive environment for all employees. All employment decisions are based on business needs, job requirements, and individual qualifications, without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, veteran status, or disability status.

2.2 Workplace Conduct & Anti-Harassment

We maintain a zero-tolerance policy toward discrimination, harassment, or bullying of any kind. Every employee has the right to work in an environment free from intimidation, hostility, or offensive behavior.

- **Reporting:** If you experience or witness harassment or unethical behavior, report it immediately to your manager, People Operations, or via the anonymous compliance hotline. Retaliation of any kind against an employee who reports a violation in good faith is strictly prohibited.

2.3 Attendance, Hours, and Remote Work Policy

- **Core Working Hours:** Our standard operating hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM in your local time zone.
- **Flexible & Remote Work:** Nexus operates under a hybrid/remote-friendly model. Team members are expected to coordinate core collaboration hours with their engineering leads or department heads. Punctuality for scheduled syncs, sprint planning sessions, and retrospectives is essential.

3. Compensation, Payroll & Performance

3.1 Pay Periods & Direct Deposit

- **Pay Schedule:** Employees are paid on a semi-monthly basis (on the 15th and the final day of each month). If a payday falls on a weekend or federal holiday, payroll will be processed on the business day immediately preceding.
- **Direct Deposit:** Direct deposit is mandatory. Pay stubs and tax documents (W-2/1099 equivalents) are accessible securely through the employee payroll portal.

3.2 Performance Reviews & Growth

We believe in continuous feedback rather than rigid annual surprises.

- **Sprint Retrospectives & 1-on-1s:** Weekly or bi-weekly 1-on-1 meetings with your manager provide ongoing alignment on goals, blockers, and career growth.
- **Formal Review Cycles:** Biannual performance cycles occur in Q2 and Q4, evaluating technical output, collaboration, leadership, and alignment with company core values. Merit increases and equity refreshers are tied to these cycles.

4. Time Off & Leave Policies

4.1 Paid Time Off (PTO)

Nexus Technologies utilizes a flexible, accrued Paid Time Off (PTO) policy designed to ensure team members get adequate rest and work-life balance.

- **Accrual Rate:** Full-time employees accrue 20 days of PTO per calendar year, credited proportionally each pay period.
- **Requesting Time Off:** PTO requests of less than 3 consecutive days should be submitted via the HR portal at least 1 week in advance. Extended leaves (exceeding 1 week) require at least 3 weeks' notice and prior manager approval to ensure proper sprint coverage.

4.2 Sick Leave & Personal Emergencies

- Employees receive up to 10 paid sick days per year for personal illness, medical appointments, or immediate family care.
- For unexpected illnesses or emergencies, notify your manager and post in your team's Slack/Teams channel as early as possible before your shift or stand-up starts.

4.3 Holidays & Company Shutdowns

- The company observes standard public holidays (e.g., New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas).
- Nexus typically observes a **winter year-end shutdown** during the final week of December to allow all employees to disconnect and recharge.

5. Security, Intellectual Property & Confidentiality

5.1 Information & Cybersecurity Guidelines

Because we handle sensitive tech stacks and enterprise client data, security is everyone's responsibility.

- **Hardware & Access:** Company-issued laptops must be secured with multi-factor authentication (MFA), corporate VPNs, and encrypted disk drives at all times. Never leave devices unattended in public spaces.
- **Password Hygiene:** Password managers must be used to generate and store complex, unique credentials for all internal tools.
- **AI & Tool Usage:** Internal LLMs and AI coding assistants must be used in compliance with data privacy guidelines. Never input proprietary source code or unmasked customer data into public, non-enterprise sandbox environments.

5.2 Intellectual Property (IP) & Code Ownership

Any software code, system architecture, documentation, designs, or inventions conceived, developed, or reduced to practice during your employment with Nexus Technologies—whether created during working hours or using company resources—belong exclusively to the Company.

6. Employee Acknowledgment

Please review this handbook thoroughly. By signing below (or acknowledging electronically via the HR onboarding portal), you confirm that you have received, read, understand, and agree to abide by the policies, guidelines, and standards set forth in this employee handbook.

Field	Detail
Employee Full Name	

Field	Detail
Department / Role	_____
Employee Signature	_____
Date	____ / ____ / 2026

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